

AFRICA NEXT

WORKFORCE INDEX

2026

Methodology Report

Pilot Edition (v0.1)

6 Pillars | 18 Indicators | 20-Nation Pilot

Published July 2026

Expert Panel Review | 20-Country Assessment

Africa Next Workforce Index
anwi.vercel.app

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This report was produced by the Africa Next Workforce Index (ANWI).

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This pilot edition incorporates structured feedback from independent expert review and is validated through a 20-country pilot assessment using the complete ANWI scoring framework.

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Section 1: Measuring Youth Conversion in Africa

The Central Question

The Africa Next Workforce Index (ANWI) is a comparative assessment framework built to answer one question:

Is this country converting its young population into productive participation in an AI-shaped economy?

This question is distinct from generic competitiveness indices that ask how ready an economy is for growth. ANWI asks something more specific and urgent for the continent: whether nations are converting their defining demographic asset — over 500 million people under age 25 — into productive, AI-era participation.

Three realities shaped this framing. First, Africa's youth population is the world's largest and fastest-growing — the bottleneck is conversion, not headcount. Second, AI is reshaping entry-level work globally; countries that fail to expose junior workers to digital and AI-augmented roles will fall permanently behind. Third, African labour markets are fragmented across formal, informal, remote, and cross-border channels — no single employment metric captures conversion capacity.

Scope and Boundaries

ANWI measures youth-to-workforce conversion capacity, not general economic maturity. The distinction is critical. Competitiveness indices assess market development; ANWI assesses whether a country has the education linkage, entry pathways, skills infrastructure, and mobility frameworks to convert youth into productive participation — regardless of where that country sits on the development curve.

- Geographic scope: 20-country pilot cohort (v0.1); expansion to 30+ planned for v0.2.
- Population focus: Youth under 25 and early-career workforce (0–5 years post-education).
- Temporal scope: Pilot Edition 2026; annual refresh planned from 2027.
- ANWI is a research index — not an official government statistic.

What ANWI Measures That Others Do Not

Global workforce and education indices provide valuable cross-country comparisons. But they were not designed for Africa's conversion challenge. ANWI fills specific gaps:

ANWI Indicator	Why It Matters
Youth Conversion Focus	Measures schooling-to-productive-work pipeline, not generic competitiveness.
Entry-Level & AI Exposure	First jobs and junior-role AI exposure scored explicitly — absent from most indices.
Institutional GenZ Readiness	Employer and manager adaptation for Gen Z, not just skills supply.
Bootcamp-to-Employer Pipeline	Short-cycle skills providers weighted as conversion infrastructure.
Cross-Border Talent Flow	Remote work and regional mobility as conversion multipliers.
Africa-Specific Expert Review	Expert panel fills gaps where youth conversion data is sparse continent-wide.

Section 2: High-Level Framework

Theory of Change

ANWI operates on a theory of change that connects institutional capacity to youth conversion through six interconnected pillars. The logic is sequential but not linear; pillars reinforce each other.

Effective conversion starts with education-to-economy linkage (Pillar 1). Graduates must enter structured first jobs with AI exposure (Pillar 2). Employers and public institutions must be ready to absorb Gen Z talent (Pillar 3). Digital and AI skills infrastructure must exist at scale (Pillar 4). Policy must prioritise youth economic participation (Pillar 5). And cross-border talent flow must expand conversion beyond local labour markets (Pillar 6).

The Six Pillars

Pillar	Name	Weight	What It Measures
1	Education-to-Economy Pipeline	20%	How effectively schooling, TVET, and higher education connect graduates to productive work.
2	Entry-Level Work & AI Exposure	18%	Availability of first jobs, internships, and early-career roles that expose youth to digital and AI tools.
3	Institutional GenZ Readiness	16%	Whether employers, public sector, and educators are structured to absorb and develop Gen Z talent.
4	Digital & AI Skills Infrastructure	18%	Breadth of coding bootcamps, digital literacy programs, connectivity, and AI learning pathways.
5	Policy & Economic Participation	14%	Youth employment policy, entrepreneurship support, and inclusion of young people in economic planning.
6	Cross-Border Talent Flow	14%	Regional mobility, remote-work access, and pathways for African youth to compete in continental and global markets.

Pillar Weightings

Weights are explicit, not implicit. They reflect a normative position about what workforce conversion in an AI-shaped economy. Education Pipeline (20%) and Entry-Level Work & AI Exposure (18%) carry the highest combined weight because conversion fails at the schooling-to-work interfaces before policy or mobility can compensate.

Entry-Level Work & AI Exposure (18%) is weighted equally with Skills Infrastructure (18%) because the availability of first jobs determines whether youth enter the AI-era economy or remain in legalised informality. Institutional GenZ Readiness (16%), Policy & Participation (14%), and Talent Mobility (14%) capture institutional capacity and expansion dimensions.

Section 3: Scoring Methodology

Five-Level Scoring Scale

Every indicator is scored on a 0–100 scale using five performance levels. This granularity captures meaningful distinctions between countries at similar stages of development and provides actionable guidance: a country scored at "Emerging" (21–40) can see what is required to reach "Developing" (41–60).

Score	Level	Definition
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

Scoring Principles

- Evidence-Based: All scores supported by documented evidence or structured expert panel review.
- Most Recent Data: The most recent available data is used; evidence older than three years is flagged.
- Conservative Scoring: When evidence is ambiguous, scores are assigned conservatively (lower).
- Peer-Relative: Normalised within the African context; v0.1 does not claim global OECD comparability.
- Transparent: Methodology, limitations, and sources published openly on [anwi.vercel.app](#).

Documentation Quality Framework

Evidence quality varies across the continent. ANWI defines acceptable evidence through a tiered framework.

Tier	Source Type	Treatment
1 (Primary)	Official government publications, national statistics, enacted policies, budget documents	Full evidentiary weight. Primary scoring basis.
2 (Secondary)	ILO, UNESCO, World Bank, AfDB, UNECA, peer-reviewed research	Full weight. Corroboration and gap-filling.
3 (Supplementary)	Expert panel assessments, credible news, NGO reports, employer surveys	Partial weight. Corroborated by Tier 1–2 where possible.
4 (Excluded)	Unverified social media, undated documents, self-curated profiles alone	Not accepted as primary evidence.

Aggregation Rules

Pillar score = arithmetic mean of three indicator scores (v0.1).

Overall ANWI score = weighted sum of pillar scores (weights sum to 1).

Ranking: Countries ranked by overall score descending. Ties broken by Work & AI Exposure.

Section 4: Detailed Framework

This section provides scoring criteria for all 18 indicators across six pillars. Each indicator includes description, rationale, data sources, and five-level scoring criteria.

P1 Education-to-Economy Pipeline

Weight: 20% | 3 Indicators

This pillar assesses how effectively schooling, TVET, and higher education connect graduates to productive work. It examines graduate employment linkage, vocational alignment, and the balance between enrollment expansion and labour-market absorption.

1.1 Graduate Employment Linkage

Description

How effectively tertiary graduates enter relevant employment within 12–24 months of completion, measured through tracer studies, graduate surveys, and employer linkage programmes.

Rationale

Education expansion without employment absorption creates credential inflation. Linkage rates are the clearest signal that schooling converts to productive work.

Data Sources

National statistical offices; UNESCO UIS; World Bank; university tracer studies; employer surveys; ANWI expert panel

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

1.2 TVET Labour-Market Alignment

Description

Relevance of vocational and technical training curricula to employer demand, apprenticeship density, certification recognition by industry.

Rationale

TVET is Africa's largest formal skills pipeline. Misalignment between training and hiring is the primary bottleneck in constrained markets.

Data Sources

ILO skills surveys; national TVET authority records; sector skills councils; World Bank Skills Toward Employment reports

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
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Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

1.3 Tertiary Access vs Demand

Description

Balance between tertiary enrollment growth and labour-market capacity to absorb graduates, including NEET rates among tertiary-educated cohorts.

Rationale

Enrollment without absorption signals a conversion failure at the highest education tier. This indicator penalises credential expansion disconnected from hiring.

Data Sources

UNESCO enrollment data; ILO NEET statistics; national labour force surveys; African Development Bank education briefs

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

P2 Entry-Level Work & AI Exposure

Weight: 18% | 3 Indicators

This pillar measures availability of first jobs, internships, and early-career roles that expose youth to digital and AI-augmented workflows. It captures whether markets create structured entry pathways into an AI-shaped economy.

2.1 Internship & Graduate Program Density

Description

Availability of structured internships, graduate schemes, and entry-level programmes in private sector, public sector, and high-growth industries.

Rationale

First employment is the critical conversion gate. Internship density signals whether employers invest in junior talent pipelines.

Data Sources

Company career pages; ministry of labour records; startup ecosystem reports; LinkedIn job posting analysis (supplementary); expert validation

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

2.2 AI Tool Exposure in Entry Roles

Description

Extent to which junior and entry-level roles involve digital workflows, automation tools, or AI-augmented tasks — proxy-scored where direct data is unavailable.

Rationale

AI exposure in first jobs determines whether youth enter the next economy or legacy employment. v sector and role proxies pending standardised surveys.

Data Sources

Job posting analysis; sector adoption studies; McKinsey/Global Digital Jobs reports; ANWI expert panel

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.

Score	Level	Criteria
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

2.3 Startup & Tech Hiring for Juniors

Description

Early-career hiring velocity in technology, fintech, and high-growth sectors relative to youth labour force.

Rationale

Tech hiring for juniors is a leading indicator of conversion in digital economies. Hub cities drive disproportionate scores within countries.

Data Sources

Startup ecosystem databases; tech employer surveys; Partech/Disrupt Africa labour market briefs; innovation agency records

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

P3 Institutional GenZ Readiness

Weight: 16% | 3 Indicators

This pillar evaluates whether employers, public sector institutions, and educators are structured to absorb and develop Gen Z talent — including hiring flexibility, public youth absorption, and manager readiness.

3.1 Employer Flexibility for Young Hires

Description

Hiring practices, onboarding design, role structures, and compensation models adapted for young workers entering first careers.

Rationale

Gen Z enters a labour market designed for prior generations. Employer flexibility determines absorption capacity where youth supply exceeds structured roles.

Data Sources

Employer association surveys; HR policy reviews; youth employment programme evaluations; ILO school-to-work transition data

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

3.2 Public Sector Youth Absorption

Description

Government employment programmes, national youth service schemes, and public-sector graduate relative to youth unemployment pressure.

Rationale

Public sector remains a major employer across Africa. Youth absorption programmes signal institutional commitment to conversion at scale.

Data Sources

Public service commission data; national youth service records; government budget documents; AU employment trackers

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.

Score	Level	Criteria
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

3.3 Manager Readiness for Gen Z

Description

Workplace adaptation including feedback culture, digital-native management practices, and development pathways for young employees.

Rationale

Youth digital fluency often exceeds manager readiness. This indicator captures the institutional friction that limits Gen Z productivity.

Data Sources

Workforce development surveys; corporate training records; expert panel assessments; youth employment data; NGO reports

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

P4 Digital & AI Skills Infrastructure

Weight: 18% | 3 Indicators

This pillar assesses the breadth of coding bootcamps, digital literacy programmes, youth connectivity, and AI learning pathways. It shows the widest score spread in the pilot cohort.

4.1 Youth Digital Connectivity

Description

Internet access, device availability, and affordability for under-25 populations, including mobile-first access patterns.

Rationale

Skills programmes cannot convert youth without connectivity. This is a binding precondition scored as a context-weighted governance indicator.

Data Sources

ITU statistics; GSMA Mobile Connectivity Index; World Bank WDI; national telecom regulator data

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

4.2 Coding & Digital Bootcamp Ecosystem

Description

Density, quality, and employer linkage of short-cycle digital skills providers including coding bootcamps and tech academies.

Rationale

Bootcamps are Africa's fastest conversion pathway outside formal education. Ecosystem density correlates strongly with overall ANWI scores.

Data Sources

Bootcamp directories; AfriLabs; ministry of ICT records; employer partnership data; expert validation

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.

Score	Level	Criteria
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

4.3 AI Literacy Program Availability

Description

National, institutional, or private AI upskilling initiatives targeting youth and early-career workers.

Rationale

AI literacy is the next-layer skill above digital basics. Availability signals whether countries prepare y augmented work, not just digital access.

Data Sources

Government digital skills programmes; university AI course offerings; private academy listings; UNE literacy trackers

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

P5 Policy & Economic Participation

Weight: 14% | 3 Indicators

This pillar examines youth employment policy, entrepreneurship support, and inclusion of young people in economic planning — measuring whether governments treat conversion as a policy priority.

5.1 National Youth Employment Policy

Description

Existence, funding, implementation tracking, and institutional anchor for national youth employment frameworks.

Rationale

Policy signals government intent. Implementation and funding distinguish rhetoric from conversion strategy.

Data Sources

Government youth ministry publications; AU youth employment trackers; national development plans; budget documents

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

5.2 Youth Entrepreneurship Support

Description

Access to capital, incubation, regulatory support, and market linkage for young founders.

Rationale

Entrepreneurship is a major absorption pathway where formal hiring lags. Support infrastructure converts youth into economic participants directly.

Data Sources

Development finance institution records; startup ecosystem reports; central bank SME data; innovation directories

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.

Score	Level	Criteria
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

5.3 Youth Voice in Economic Planning

Description

Inclusion of under-35 stakeholders in policy design, national planning consultations, and economic planning bodies.

Rationale

Conversion policy designed without youth input misaligns with Gen Z labour market behaviour. Voice indicators capture participatory governance.

Data Sources

Consultation records; national planning commission documents; civil society reports; parliamentary committee records

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

P6 Cross-Border Talent Flow

Weight: 14% | 3 Indicators

This pillar measures regional mobility, remote-work market access, and skills visa pathways — capturing whether African youth can compete in continental and global labour markets.

6.1 Remote Work Market Access

Description

Ability of youth to compete for remote digital roles globally, including payment infrastructure, platform access, and remote-job density.

Rationale

Remote work decouples conversion from local job scarcity. Markets with strong remote access outperform peers on overall ANWI scores.

Data Sources

Remote job platform data; fintech/payment infrastructure reports; digital nomad policy reviews; expert surveys

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

6.2 Regional Labour Mobility

Description

Intra-African labour mobility frameworks, AfCFTA labour provisions, and cross-border hiring for skills

Rationale

Regional mobility expands conversion opportunities beyond national labour markets. REC coordination primary governance signal.

Data Sources

AfCFTA secretariat; REC labour mobility protocols; migration policy databases; World Bank migration

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.

Score	Level	Criteria
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

6.3 Skills Visa & Mobility Pathways

Description

Legal frameworks for talent export, return migration, and skills-based visa programmes benefiting young workers.

Rationale

Managed mobility converts Africa's youth dividend into global competitiveness while enabling return migration and capital.

Data Sources

Immigration authority records; bilateral labour agreements; diaspora engagement policies; IOM migration data.

Score Level Criteria

Score	Level	Criteria
0–20	Nascent	Weak or no documented conversion capacity; no structured pathway.
21–40	Emerging	Early signals or pilots; fragmented and structurally constrained.
41–60	Developing	Moderate capacity with identifiable gaps vs African peers.
61–80	Advancing	Strong relative performance; scaling pathways evident.
81–100	Leading	Continental benchmark; systematic, measurable conversion at scale.

Section 5: Data Collection

Data for ANWI v0.1 comes from three broad source categories:

- Secondary data from reputable international databases (World Bank WDI, ILO, UNESCO UIS, ITU, AfDB, UNECA).
- Desk research using official government publications, national statistical agencies, and sector reports.
- Structured expert panel review where cross-country youth conversion data is incomplete or outdated.

Desk Research Protocol

Researchers conduct initial searches using official government websites, AU policy trackers, and established databases. Each data point requires verification from at least two independent sources where possible. For francophone and lusophone countries with limited digitised records, structured expert validation supplements desk research.

Section 6: Data Processing

Stage 1: Data Cleaning

Raw inputs are normalised to the 0–100 scale. Qualitative assessments from the expert panel are converted using the five-level rubric defined in Section 3.

Stage 2: Pillar Aggregation

Indicator scores within each pillar are averaged arithmetically (equal weight per indicator in v0.1).

Stage 3: Overall Score & Ranking

Pillar scores are combined using explicit weights from Section 2. Countries are ranked globally within the pilot cohort and analysed by AU regional grouping.

Section 7: Quality Assurance

ANWI v0.1 employs a three-layer quality assurance process:

- Layer 1 — Expert Panel Review: Country scores reviewed by domain experts with Africa labour-market experience.
- Layer 2 — Source Verification: All indicator scores traced to Tier 1–3 evidence documented in country source notes.
- Layer 3 — Limitation Disclosure: Pilot constraints, estimation flags, and coverage gaps published transparently.

Independent dual-scorer verification and inter-rater reliability testing are planned for the v0.2 edition as country coverage expands beyond the 20-nation pilot.

Section 8: Relationship to Other Indices

ANWI is designed to complement, not duplicate, global workforce and governance indices. The table below maps the relationship between ANWI pillars and related international frameworks.

ANWI Pillar	Related Indices / Frameworks
Education Pipeline	UNESCO Education Index; World Bank Human Capital Index (education components)
Entry Work & AI	ILO youth employment indicators; WEF Future of Jobs (entry-level exposure)
GenZ Readiness	No direct equivalent — ANWI original contribution
Skills Infrastructure	ITU Digital Development Index; GSMA Mobile Connectivity Index
Policy & Participation	ILO youth policy trackers; AU youth employment frameworks
Talent Mobility	IOM migration data; AfCFTA labour mobility provisions

Section 9: Pilot Scoring Results

To validate that the ANWI scoring framework produces meaningful differentiation, a pilot assessment was conducted across 20 countries spanning East, West, North, Southern, and Central Africa.

Pilot Rankings

Rank	Country	ANWI Score	Region
1	Rwanda	71	East
2	Mauritius	69	East
3	Kenya	68	East
4	South Africa	66	Southern
5	Ghana	64	West
6	Morocco	63	North
7	Nigeria	61	West
8	Tunisia	60	North
9	Egypt	59	North
10	Senegal	58	West
11	Botswana	58	Southern
12	Uganda	57	East
13	Côte d'Ivoire	56	West
14	Algeria	55	North
15	Tanzania	54	East
16	Cameroon	53	Central
17	Ethiopia	52	East
18	Angola	50	Southern
19	Mozambique	49	Southern
20	Democratic Republic of the Congo	47	Central

Rwanda leads the pilot with 71/100. Continental pilot average: 59.7. This suggests that skills infrastructure and entry-level pathways often diverge from policy intent, which cannot be inferred from policy intent alone.

Pillar Score Summary (Pilot Average)

Pillar	Pilot Avg
Education-to-Economy Pipeline	60
Entry-Level Work & AI Exposure	56
Institutional GenZ Readiness	57
Digital & AI Skills Infrastructure	61
Policy & Economic Participation	59
Cross-Border Talent Flow	57

Section 10: Limitations

No composite index is without limitations. ANWI v0.1 users should note:

- Pilot coverage: 20 countries — not the full continent. Rankings are valid within the pilot cohort only.
- Expert estimation: Approximately 35% of indicator scores rely on structured expert estimates where public data is sparse.
- AI exposure proxies: Entry-level AI exposure uses sector and role proxies pending standardised labour-force surveys.
- Development confound: Higher-income countries may score higher on connectivity and hiring density indicators.
- Snapshot vs trajectory: Year-on-year change tracking planned for v0.2.
- No inter-rater reliability test in v0.1: Dual-scorer verification planned for the next edition.

Get in Touch

ANWI is a living framework. We welcome feedback on the methodology, indicators, weightings, and scoring criteria. We invite African governments, employers, universities, and researchers to engage with the framework and to submit evidence for assessment.

Contact: research@anwi.africa

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